

Resumes: Strategic Planning / Business Development

SKILLS

Skills sought within your field	Examples of how this skill can be demonstrated on a resume.
Communication – communicate verbally and in writing in order to summarize complex business problems simply and effectively	<u>Education</u> - Member of debate team; thesis or specific research <u>Experience</u> - Developed growth strategy for a \$1B Consumer Products company; presented strategy to the Board and generated approval <u>Additional</u> - Writing book on Asian Financial Crisis
Pattern Recognition – recognize trends and make accurate forecasts	<u>Education</u> - Sector-specific club or extra-curricular experience <u>Experience</u> - Identified new trends in visa fraud that led to the discovery of over 200 cases of consular fraud, several involving organized criminals and human/drug traffickers <u>Additional</u> - Navigator for endurance sailing team
Problem Solving – formulate creative solutions based on incomplete information in ambiguous situations	<u>Education</u> - Finalist, strategic management case competition <u>Experience</u> - Identified gaps in clients' online business performance and led a team in developing a plan to increase efficiency and boost website traffic <u>Additional</u> - Planned successful solo climbs, Mt. Everest (1996), Kilimanjaro (1994)
Relationship Building – structure, negotiate, manage both new and ongoing relationships	<u>Education</u> - Co Chair of the Corporate Management and Strategy Group, responsible for developing external corporate relationships for recruiting and speaking events <u>Experience</u> - Built and managed embassy relationships with ministers and ministry officials in cabinet offices of energy, finance, transportation and education <u>Additional</u> - Volunteer, University Development Office

Skills sought within your field	Examples of how this skill can be demonstrated on a resume.
Negotiation and presentation skills – prove very useful when persuading others to change a process, tactic, or strategic direction or when conducting a transaction with an outside firm.	<u>Education</u> - Co Chair, Debate Club <u>Experience</u> - Challenged assumptions and created new negotiating strategies that ended two years of deadlock in privatization and commercial law discussions
Analytical Skills – specifically, blending your skills in pattern recognition and quantitative analysis to produce a corporate epiphany or paradigm-changing strategy	<u>Education</u> - Conducted research on privatization, corporate structure, and direct investment patterns in East Asia <u>Experience</u> - Analyzed and assessed potential brand acquisitions and licensing arrangements for the wireless market in India <u>Additional</u> - Coached junior high football team, which won divisional championship

ATTRIBUTES

Attributes sought within your field.	Examples of how this attribute can be demonstrated on a resume.
Egalitarian – most business development and strategy managers must work well with both bankers and the rank-and-file members of a diverse organization	<u>Education</u> - Active member, Giving Something Back, philanthropic group <u>Experience</u> - Led a multi-national team that annually adjudicated 80K cases, generating \$3.6 million in visa fees - Collaborated on a team consisting of the Director, Regional Sales Managers and 50 field sales personnel to set-up XYZ company's national sales & distribution network <u>Additional</u> - Helped build 50 homes for Habitat for Humanity since 1996

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Internally Motivated – corporate development and strategy professionals are not closely directed by their superiors; to succeed, you must actively seek out opportunities for the company	<u>Education</u> • Thesis or specific research; alternatively, initiative during school to organize relevant topic (e.g. socially relevant drives, school festivals, etc.) • Initiated a student trek to Dubai over winter break to meet with firms in the clean tech industry <u>Experience</u> • Proposed, implemented, and led the first US government, political-economic lobbying effort aimed at Nigeria’s legislature <u>Additional</u> • Co-founded non-profit group that supports private education scholarships for African students in the U.S.
Integrity – you need to demonstrate that you are willing to communicate the truth, even if the answer is undesirable, and that you can do this in a manner that supports the organization’s goals	<u>Education</u> • Member of University’s Ethics Committee for past two years <u>Experience</u> • Discovered financial discrepancies while conducting an annual audit at a large consumer packaged goods client; reported findings to senior management <u>Additional</u> • Loyal Utah Jazz fan and true-blue Canadian farm boy
Passion for the Industry – you need to demonstrate that you possess an ongoing desire to better understand the economics/markets of the firm; industry experience is helpful, but not usually a requirement, just make sure that you understand the values, strategic constraints, trends and economics of the industry	<u>Education</u> • Co Chair, Media and Entertainment Group <u>Experience</u> • Drafted market reports and shared recommendations with senior decision-makers <u>Additional</u> • Organized computer club for local elementary students (i.e. for tech sector-related job search)
Strategic Thinking - capacity to think broadly and strategically about an industry and then apply it to the company; also have the ability to relate adjacent-industry experiences to individual company’s strategy	<u>Experience</u> • Conducted industry channel analysis and recommended distribution changes that increased market share by 5% • Conceptualized and developed a prototype to demonstrate the optimal use of third party software <u>Additional</u> • Volunteer for Junior Achievement (career focus on area of interest)

Decisive & Rigorous – it is very important to display an ability to provide a suggested course of action based on the available facts and information you have analyzed while demonstrating an ability to evaluate and assess alternative courses of actions and be able to defend your recommendation	Experience Recommended company XYZ pursue international expansion in India instead of China given underlying market demand trends, regulatory environment and existing capabilities
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AREAS OF EXPERTISE

Areas of expertise sought within your field:	Examples of how this expertise can be demonstrated on a resume.
Financial Models – critical when conducting feasibility and project analysis; have knowledge of how to create financial models that accurately predict revenues, expenses, and cash flows associated with various deal structures and determine the key sensitivities and drivers of such projections	Education - Modeled market activity of telecommunications industry as part of class project Experience - Developed financial model to assess key cost drivers and performed scenario analysis to evaluate the five-year business plan for a regional retail chain
Accounting – a knowledge of rules is helpful when assessing the quality of a valuation and performing due diligence	Education - Bachelor of Science in Accounting - Received 2-year accounting program scholarship Experience - Discovered a significant accounting error that resulted in a new valuation and saved \$15M in acquisition costs Additional - Volunteer in providing free tax services to help inner-city businesses
Transactions – you should feel comfortable with and be able to demonstrate comfort with sourcing, developing, negotiating and closing deals	Education - Worked with University's Development office to raise \$75M for new, endowed Chair for the Department of Humanities Experience - Valued assets, identified buyers and negotiated a \$25M divestiture for XYZ company

International Experience – Expansion overseas is critical to the future growth of any business today. Ability to show evidence of having experiences outside of home country through education, professional and/or personal experiences	<u>Education</u> • Studied abroad at the London School of Economics for one semester • Alternatively, include past international full-time/part-time study experiences <u>Experience</u> • Directed international licensing projects in China and Japan • Developed the global brand strategy for a consumer products company, working with teams across four different countries <u>Additional</u> • Fluent (written and spoken) Chinese, German, and English
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